PHIL YOUNG'S ENGLISH SCHOOL

Extreme Jobs, Hobbies & Sports · Student Pack

B2+ / C1

Advanced TOEFL lesson — why do some people crave adventure and risk?

NAME _____ DATE _____ GROUP _____

1 Interview warm-up

SPEAKING · PAIRS

Answer each question for about 45 seconds. No preparation time. After speaking, write a few key words or a short answer in the space.

1. What is the most adventurous thing you have ever done? How did you feel before, during and after it?

2. Would you ever try bungee jumping or skydiving? Why or why not?

3. Some people say that people in dangerous jobs, like firefighters, should earn much more than other workers. Do you agree? Why?

4. Running a marathon is painful and exhausting. Why do you think so many people choose to do it?

5. Do you think people are born risk-takers, or do they learn to enjoy risk? Give an example.

While your partner speaks, write:

One strong phrase they used:

One moment they hesitated or repeated themselves:

2 Topic vocabulary

VOCABULARY · READING

A Match each word (1–10) to its definition (a–j). Number 0 is an example.

> *Example: 0. thrill → **k** (a sudden feeling of excitement and pleasure)*

#	WORD	ANSWER
1.	adrenaline	
2.	endurance	
3.	daredevil	
4.	reckless	
5.	calculated risk	
6.	thrive on (something)	
7.	push your limits	
8.	hazardous	
9.	exhilarating	
10.	overcome (a fear)	

	DEFINITION
a	not thinking about the possible danger of your actions
b	the ability to keep doing something difficult or tiring for a long time
c	dangerous, especially to people's health or safety
d	a person who enjoys doing dangerous things
e	a hormone your body releases when you are frightened or excited
f	a danger you accept after thinking carefully about it
g	very exciting and enjoyable
h	to enjoy and do well in a situation other people find difficult
i	to try to do more than you thought you could
j	to succeed in controlling a feeling or problem
k	*a sudden feeling of excitement and pleasure*

B Complete the paragraph with the words from Part A.

~~ADRENALINE~~ · ENDURANCE · DAREDEVIL · RECKLESS · CALCULATED RISK · THRIVE ON · PUSH YOUR LIMITS · HAZARDOUS · EXHILARATING · OVERCOME

> *Example: When you jump, your body releases **adrenaline**, so your heart beats faster.*

Some people seem to **1.** _____ danger: the more frightening a situation is, the happier they feel. A typical **2.** _____ will jump off a bridge attached to a rope and describe the experience as **3.** _____. Others prefer tests of **4.** _____, such as a 100-kilometer race through the mountains, where the goal is to **5.** _____ and keep going long after your body wants to stop. Firefighters, on the other hand, work in **6.** _____ conditions because it is their job, not their hobby. Experts point out that most of these people are not **7.** _____: before every climb, jump or rescue, they plan carefully and take only a **8.** _____. For many beginners, the hardest part is simply learning to **9.** _____ their fear of heights.

3 Academic lecture

LISTENING · NOTE-TAKING

A **Before you listen. Why do you think some people enjoy danger? Write two ideas.**

1. _____

2. _____

B **First listening. Write the main idea of the lecture in one sentence.**

_____

_____

C **Second listening. Complete the note frame.**

How to take notes

1. The lecture follows the order of the rows below: first a definition, then who seeks sensation most, three reasons, three examples and the conclusion.
2. In **Claim**, write the professor's main point for that section in 2–5 words.
3. In **Evidence / example**, write one fact, name, date or example he gives to support it.
4. Write notes, not sentences. Abbreviations and symbols (↑, ↓, →, =, ~) are fine.

SECTION	CLAIM	EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE
Example: Definition	*need for new, varied, intense experiences*	*Zuckerman (US psych.), 1960s; high scorers → bored easily*
Who seeks sensation most		
Reason 1: the brain		
Reason 2: risk perception		
Reason 3: flow		
Example 1: bungee jumping		
Example 2: marathons		
Example 3: firefighters		
Professor's conclusion		

3 Academic lecture — questions

LISTENING

D Use your notes only. Circle the best answer (a, b, c or d).

1. What is the lecture mainly about?
   a. How to reduce injuries in extreme sports
   b. Why some people are drawn to risk, and how their motives differ
   c. The history of bungee jumping
   d. Why firefighters should earn higher salaries
2. According to the professor, what is sensation seeking?
   a. A fear of new or intense experiences
   b. A medical condition that makes people reckless
   c. The need for new, varied and intense experiences
   d. The ability to stay calm in an emergency
3. When does sensation seeking tend to be highest?
   a. In early childhood
   b. In the late teens and early twenties
   c. In middle age
   d. It stays the same throughout life.
4. What is the professor's view of the research on dopamine?
   a. It proves that dopamine causes all risk-taking.
   b. It has been rejected by most psychologists.
   c. It applies only to professional athletes.
   d. It is promising, but the evidence is still mixed.
5. Why does the professor mention two friends on a roller coaster?
   a. To show that the same activity can feel very different to different people
   b. To warn that roller coasters are more dangerous than they look
   c. To compare amusement parks with extreme sports
   d. To explain how the body produces adrenaline
6. According to the lecture, what is flow?
   a. A rush of fear just before a dangerous jump
   b. The speed at which a runner finishes a marathon
   c. A state of total concentration when the challenge of a task matches your skill
   d. A training method used by firefighters
7. What does the professor say about the first modern bungee jumps?
   a. They took place in New Zealand in the 1990s.
   b. They were part of a scientific experiment.
   c. They were made by professional stunt performers.
   d. They were made in England in 1979 by members of a university club.
8. According to more recent studies, what may play a bigger role in the "runner's high"?
   a. Chemicals called endocannabinoids
   b. Endorphins
   c. Dehydration during the race
   d. The cheering of the crowd
9. What can be inferred about why many firefighters stay in the job for decades?
   a. Their pay increases every year.
   b. They depend on the adrenaline of emergencies.
   c. Their motivation comes mainly from purpose, not from the thrill.
   d. They have few other career options.
10. What is the professor's main conclusion?
    a. Extreme sports should be more strictly regulated.
    b. Risk-takers have different motives, and most of them plan carefully.
    c. Sensation seeking is mainly genetic.
    d. Bungee jumpers and firefighters have the same personality.

4 Town council debate

SPEAKING · GROUPS

A 60-second summary.

Plan for 1 minute using your notes, then summarize the lecture to your partner. Cover: what sensation seeking is, two reasons some people seek risk, one of the three examples, and the professor's conclusion.

B Role cards.

How the debate works

1. Read the situation below. Your teacher gives you ONE card.
2. **Advocates:** read your card and plan a 1-minute pitch (4 min). **Chair:** plan your questions.
3. Each advocate pitches for 1 minute. Use your strengths and answer the criticism before anyone else says it.
4. Open discussion: the Chair asks hard questions and advocates respond to each other.
5. The Chair chooses ONE policy and explains the decision in 30 seconds.

> *Example pitch opening: The main reason rescues must stay free is that **people who fear a bill wait too long to call**. While it's true that **taxpayers cover the cost**, in the long run late rescues cost far more.*

The situation. Rescue calls in your mountain town have tripled in ten years, mostly for climbers, skiers and hikers. Rescues are free and paid for by local taxes. The council must choose ONE policy today.

✂ Cut along the dashed lines. One card per student.

ADVOCATE

Rescue team chief: keep rescues free

Your strengths: people who are afraid of a bill wait too long to call for help, and late rescues are slower, more dangerous for the team and more expensive.

Expect criticism: local taxpayers keep paying for other people's risky choices, and calls keep rising.

ADVOCATE

Tourism board: free rescues + safety campaign

Your strengths: climbers, skiers and hikers bring millions to local hotels and shops; better trail signs and free safety courses would cut accidents without scaring visitors away.

Expect criticism: campaigns are slow, their results are hard to measure, and taxpayers still pay for every rescue.

ADVOCATE

Extreme athlete: charge only reckless people

Your strengths: most adventurers plan carefully; only people who ignore closed trails or storm warnings should pay, which is fair and encourages responsible behavior.

Expect criticism: who decides what is reckless? Every bill could become an argument, and people may still delay calling.

ADVOCATE

Insurance company: required rescue insurance

Your strengths: a small fee with every climbing, skiing or trail permit covers the full cost of rescues, so nobody gets a huge bill and taxpayers pay nothing.

Expect criticism: it is hard to check every day hiker, it adds paperwork, and local residents may resent paying a fee.

ADVOCATE

Local taxpayer: everyone pays their own bill

Your strengths: if you choose a hazardous hobby, you should pay for your own rescue, just as you pay for your own equipment and lift tickets.

Expect criticism: a rescue can cost thousands of dollars; poorer visitors may not call for help, and the town could get bad publicity.

CHAIR

Council Chair

Your job: give each advocate 1 minute, then ask hard questions: Will people still call for help early? Is it fair to local residents? How will we enforce it?

At the end, choose ONE policy and explain your decision in 30 seconds.

USEFUL LANGUAGE

The main reason is that… / While it's true that…, … / I'd argue that… / That's a fair point, but… / In the long run…

5 Speculating about causes and motives

GRAMMAR

A Discovery. Underline the words that show how sure the speaker is, or that explain a cause or motive.

> *Example: Boredom **could be** part of the reason.*

1. That might explain why some people get bored so easily in a routine job.
2. Part of the answer may lie in the brain.
3. Their interest in danger seems to stem from a stronger response to novelty.
4. The first jumpers must have felt terrified as they stepped off the bridge.
5. They can't have known exactly how the ropes would behave.
6. For most firefighters, the job is driven by a desire to help, which explains why many stay in it for decades.

DEDUCTION (HOW SURE?)	CAUSE AND MOTIVE
must / must have + past participle (almost sure: yes)	stem from / result from + noun
might / may / could (have) + past participle (possible)	be driven by / be motivated by + noun
can't / couldn't (have) + past participle (almost sure: no)	which explains why / that's why + clause
seem to / appear to + verb	the cause lies in + noun
probably / is likely to + verb	due to / because of + noun

B Speculate about each situation in one sentence. Use a different structure from the box each time.

> *Example: Ana quit her bank job to become a mountain guide. → She **must have been** bored in the office.*

1. Leo has run 30 marathons in five years.

2. Mia screamed all the way down on her first bungee jump.

3. The climber didn't check the weather forecast before he set off into a storm.

4. Thousands of people apply to become firefighters every year, even though the job is dangerous.

5. Sensation seeking is usually highest in people under 25.

6. My grandfather went skydiving on his 80th birthday.

C Build a Sentence. Put the chunks in the correct order. Add punctuation.

How to build a sentence: 1. Use every chunk once. Add no new words. **2.** Find the subject and main verb first, then place the other chunks. **3.** Start with a capital letter and end with a period.

> *Example: have / they / must / trained hard → **They must have trained hard.***

1. must / felt / she / have / terrified

2. their work / driven by / is / a desire to help

3. can't / known / have / the danger / they

4. stem from / may / their love of risk / childhood experiences

5. that's / why / they / under pressure / stay calm

6 Academic Discussion post

WRITING · 10 MIN

Time: 10 minutes. Minimum: 100 words. Use at least two structures from Worksheet 5 and one concession.

> **Professor Okafor:** Many schools organize adventure trips, such as rock climbing, white-water rafting or long mountain hikes, to help teenagers build confidence and resilience. Other schools have stopped these trips because of the risk of injury and the cost of insurance. Should schools offer risky activities like these? Why or why not?

> **Sofia:** Yes, they should. On my school climbing trip I was terrified at first, but with good instructors I reached the top. Facing a real challenge taught me to overcome fear in a way no classroom could.

> **Daniel:** I disagree. One accident can change a student's life forever, and the school is responsible for every child. Families who want their children to try extreme activities can do that on weekends, outside school.

Your response:

Peer review checklist. Tick each box for your partner's post.

☐ States a clear position early
☐ Adds a new idea, not a repeat of Sofia or Daniel
☐ Supports it with a reason and a specific example
☐ Uses at least two structures from Worksheet 5 (underline them)
☐ Uses at least one concession (although / while it's true that…)
☐ Uses at least two words from Worksheet 2
☐ 100 words or more

One thing your partner did well:

One thing to improve:

7 Homework — Write an Email

ABOUT 120 WORDS

> You signed up for the City Charity Marathon next month, but you injured your knee during training. Write an email to the race organizer, Ms. Carter. In your email:
>
> - explain what happened
> - ask to switch to the 10K race or move your entry to next year
> - explain why the charity is important to you

Use a polite, formal register, at least one structure from Worksheet 5 and two words from Worksheet 2.

To: Ms. Carter, Race Organizer **Subject:** _____